

SYLLABUS
MGMT 25400
LEGAL FOUNDATIONS OF BUSINESS I
Spring Term 2026 in Rawls 1011

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TEXT: Anderson's Business Law and the Legal Environment, Comprehensive Volume, the 24th, 23rd or 22nd can be used, and the 22nd might save students money. Authors-Twomey, Jennings, Publisher-Thomson/South-Western.

DESCRIPTION OF THE COURSE: Foundations of law, judicial process, constitutional law, regulatory law, law of torts, contracts, agency law, property law, ethics and social forces, bankruptcy, insurance, administrative agencies, employment law, and land use controls.

SUBJECT AREA AND COURSE CONTENT: This course is designed to introduce the college student to different aspects of the law. It is hoped that at the end of the course, the student will have a workable understanding of law in the American business system and how individuals and organizations function within that legal system. Emphasis is placed on identifying the legal issues, outcomes, and reasoning of the legal issues studied. I intend to present material consistent with current legal trends and the types of legal issues which students will most likely be confronted.

COURSE OBJECTIVES: This class is a flipped course, which means the traditional lectures are recorded, so students can watch them at any time class, and students can slow the lectures down to take notes, and students can watch the lectures a second time, if students are so inclined. What this means is that in class the students are expected to have watched the videos for the materials to be covered that day before class, and the classroom will be primarily for discussion, questions, and projects, unless students have not made themselves familiar with the materials assigned before class. In class, a variety of methods will be used. The course will include lectures, legal discussions, projects and assignments. However, you are expected to watch the videos and read each chapter carefully, even though not every section will be covered in class. Also, there will be occasional outside reading assignments beyond the text chapters and projects.

GRADING: Each student earns his or her own grade. I see grades as feedback indicating how well you have done against my standards. Grades tell (at least to some degree) what has been learned. They are not the goal of learning. The following represents the weight given to the different elements:

80% Tests. Tests are over lectures, class discussions, videos, and materials in the chapters. Tests are open book, open notes, and will be given on Brightspace. Students will have 80 minutes to take each test.

Tentative date of exams, subject to the nature of the classroom discussion and the flipped class are below:

1st test February 5, 2026

2nd test March 12, 2026

3rd test April 14, 2026

4th test during finals week

If any students have accommodations through Purdue's DRC Testing, please let me know as soon as possible, so that accommodations can be made.

20% Research, writing assignments, and in class project questions.

***In class project questions cannot be made up unless a student has a Purdue acceptable reason. There is no extra credit available.

Class participation is very important to me, and hopefully will be to you in learning the material covered in this course. For this reason and due to the content and complexity of the subject matter, regular class attendance is extremely important! Not only do I want your attendance in class, but also a well-thought-out participation in the class discussions.

CLASS PROCEDURES: Tests cannot be made up for any reason; these are really indicative of student preparation and attendance in class. But, as in any area of law, there are exceptions. I do not enjoy preparing make-up tests. To be fair to people taking the test at the required times, the make-up test will be harder and more specific. Before a student will be allowed to take a make-up test, he or she must notify me and provide a reasonable excuse before the regular test has been given. Any outside reading assignments will be assigned in class. The instructor reserves the right to alter any aspect of the information given in this syllabus.

PARTICIPATION: To obtain full benefit from this course, you will want to attend each session and to read the required readings prior to class. You owe this to yourself and to your fellow students. In addition to the readings, you are strongly encouraged to bring current items of interest to class, whether from a business periodical or local paper. Students who get into academic trouble are those who regularly miss class, and by the time they realize the importance of attending class, it is too late. Therefore, if you miss more than three classes, for any unexcused reason, your course grade will be decreased by one letter grade. Your participation is not usually graded, but from time to time when participation has been particularly outstanding, the final grade is boosted somewhat, or if participation is below standard, the grade is reduced. Hopefully, you will remember some of the issues we will discuss long after you've forgotten your grade.

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Spring TERM 2026
TENTATIVE COURSE SCHEDULE

Chapters on the first test are Introduction & Chapter 1- Nature and Sources of Law, Chapter 2- Court Systems, Chapter 3- Ethics, Social Forces, and the Law, Chapter 4-The Constitution as the Foundation of the Legal Environment, Chapter 5- Government Regulation and Chapter 6- Administrative Agencies.

1st TEST, opens on Thursday, February 5, 2026 at 9:00 am (EDT) and closes the next day, Friday, February 6, 2026, at 9:00 am (EDT), and students will have 75 minutes to take the test, unless indicated otherwise.

Chapters for this next section on the second test are Crimes, Torts, Nature and Classes of Contract, Formation of Contracts: Offer & Acceptance, Capacity, Consideration, Legality and Writing.

2nd TEST, opens on Thursday, March 12, 2026, at 9:00 am (EDT) and closes the next day, Friday, March 13, 2026, at 9:00 am (EDT), students will have 75 minutes to take the test, unless indicated otherwise.

Chapters for this next section which we be covered on the 3rd test are Personal Property & Bailments, Real Property, Environmental Law and Land Use Controls and Bankruptcy.

3rd TEST, opens on Tuesday, April 14, 2026, at 9:00 am (EDT) and closes the next day, Wednesday, April 15, 2026 at 9:00 am (EDT). Students will have 75 minutes to take the test, unless indicated otherwise.

Chapters for this next section which we be covered on the 4th test are Insurance, Agency, Third Persons, Regulation of Employment, and Equal Employment Opportunity.

4th TEST is during Finals Week.

The Instructor reserves the right to alter any aspect of this information.

In order to save students money on books, the chapters indicated are from the 22nd edition. Below indicates the differences between the 22nd, 23rd and 24th editions.

Chapters

22nd edition	23rd edition	<u>24th edition</u>
1 ,2 ,3, 4, 5 & 6	1, 2, 3, 4, 5 & 6	1, 2,3, 4, 5 & 6
8	7	7
9	8	8
12-17	11-16	11-16
21, 49, 50 & 35	20, 48, 49 & 34	20, 46, 47 & 32
36-40	35-39	33-37

Below is the traditional grading.

A 94 or above

A- 90-93
B+ 87-89
B 84-86
B- 80-83
C+ 77-79
C 74-76
C- 70-73
D+ 67-69
D 64-66
D- 60-63
F Below 60

If the average for the courses are below 3.0, I will curve the classes up to about a 3.0. I will not curve a course below the traditional grading scale.

Purdue University Code of Honor

The purpose of the Purdue University academic community is to search for truth and to endeavor to communicate with each other. Self-discipline and a sense of social obligation within each individual are necessary for the fulfillment of these goals. It is the responsibility of all Purdue students to live by this code, not out of fear of the consequences of its violation, but out of personal self-respect. As human beings we are obliged to conduct ourselves with high integrity. As members of the civil community we have to conduct ourselves as responsible citizens in accordance with the rules and regulations governing all residents of the state of Indiana and of the local community. As members of the Purdue University community, we have the responsibility to observe all University regulations.

To foster a climate of trust and high standards of academic achievement, Purdue University is committed to cultivating academic integrity and expects students to exhibit the highest standards of honor in their scholastic endeavors. Academic integrity is essential to the success of Purdue University's mission. As members of the academic community, our foremost interest is toward achieving noble educational goals and our foremost responsibility is to ensure that academic honesty prevails.

Academic Regulations, <https://catalog.purdue.edu/content.php?catoid=15&navoid=18634#grades-and-grade-reports>